



June 2, 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to offer my highest and most enthusiastic recommendation for Mamadou Ba, who served as a mentor in the Verizon Emerging Tech Impact Program at the College of Staten Island during the Spring 2026 cohort. Over the course of five weeks, Mamadou demonstrated exceptional leadership, patience, and a genuine commitment to empowering the next generation of young innovators.

As the mentor for Team Purple, Mamadou guided a group of high school students through the full arc of developing a Queue Management App for Seniors — from identifying a real community problem to designing and presenting a technology-driven solution at the program's Tech Showcase. What stood out most about Mamadou was his ability to meet each student exactly where they were. Mamadou brought a rare combination of technical understanding and deep empathy to his mentorship. His guidance helped the team navigate the complexities of user-centered design, accessibility considerations, and the ethical implications of building technology for a vulnerable population.

Beyond the technical and strategic guidance, Mamadou was a role model. He consistently showed up prepared, engaged, and encouraging. He celebrated small wins, helped the team push through moments of doubt, and fostered a spirit of collaboration that elevated the entire group.

I recommend Mamadou Ba without reservation. His dedication, emotional intelligence, and ability to inspire young people are qualities that will serve him and any organization fortunate enough to work with him exceptionally well. He is exactly the kind of mentor every program hopes to find.

With warmest regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Seyi Fakoya". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Seyi" and last name "Fakoya" clearly distinguishable.

Seyi Fakoya

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